



Above The main square in Brussels – the Grand Place – dates back to the Middle Ages



Above Steamed *moules marinière* cooked with garlic, white wine, parsley, and shallots are eaten using empty shells as pincers

Three Days in Brussels

Brussels is full of wonderful sights, food, and drink, and its attractions can easily be sampled by walking or taking the hop-on, hop-off buses.

DAY ONE Begin at the magnificent **Grand Place**, and take a short detour to the city mascot, the little bronze figure of the **Manneken-Pis** (“Peeing Boy”). Walk back through the elegant **Galeries St-Hubert** arcade to the Gothic **Cathédrale des Saints Michel et Gudule**. End the day at the **Musée des Instruments de Musique**.

DAY TWO Start the day at the **flea market** in the **Place du Jeu de Balle**. Then walk through the **Place du Grand Sablon**, with its upmarket antique and chocolate shops, to reach the **Musées Royaux des Beaux-Arts**, a monument to Belgian art.

DAY THREE Visit the **Horta Museum**, a shrine to Art Nouveau set in the home of its pioneer, Victor Horta. Then head for the wonderfully quirky **Musée Wiertz**, a 19th-century art studio. Continue to the **Parc du Cinquantenaire**, with its three museums: military, historic automobiles, and world-class antique treasures.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Brussels has an international **airport** at **Zaventem**, three major **train stations**, and an extensive city network of **trams** and **buses**.

WHERE TO STAY

Sleep Well Youth Hostel (inexpensive) is more of a budget hotel than a hostel, with a good choice of accommodations close to downtown. www.sleepwell.be

Noga (moderate) is a neat, elegant, well-run hotel in a tranquil location, close to the Place Sainte-Catherine. www.nogahotel.com

Le Dixseptième (expensive) is a stylish boutique hotel in the 17th-century residence of the Spanish ambassador, close to the Grand Place. www.ledixseptieme.be

TOURIST INFORMATION

Grand Place; www.visitbrussels.be